

Imation Disc Stakka

As backed up data bulges on CDs and DVDs, it'll soon be impossible to find which disk has what! Just for people like you (and us!), Imation has introduced the Disc Stakka, which is a multiple disk storage-cum-indexing device that lets you store up to 100 disks along the radius.

At first glance, the Disc Stakka seems like a large box, but is surprisingly light. It connects to the PC's USB port and needs no additional power supply. It has a slot-type disk loader that accepts disks regardless of which side you insert.

It comes with an OpdiTracker—a CD/DVD indexing software that integrates the Stakka seamlessly into XP and creates and maintains a database of disks.

When the unit is full, stack another unit above it, and connect the two—and stack as many as five units—500 disks! However, it's not perfect—there's no disk reader and it can't manually eject a disk. Still, it's an indispensable peripheral for businesses and SoHos. Again, at Rs 13,999, it's heavy on the pocket!



Company **GlobalNet KVM Solutions**

Price **Rs 13,999**

Phone **022-24321530**

E-mail **raj@globalnetindiainfo.com**

Web site **www.imation.com**

Rating



Samsung SGH-C230 Mobile Phone

This One Rocks!

The SGH-C230 cell phone from Samsung is their latest salvo in the entry-level segment with multiple features at a competitive price.

Sporting a dual tone black and metallic grey outfit, the C230 has a better finish than models in this category from competitors. A dash of chrome lining the display and the soft menu buttons adds some jazz.

The blue backlit keys, though small, are usable but people with large fingers will struggle with the bottom line of keys. The 65K colour display is the best we have seen on an entry level phone—vivid and bright. With an excellent stereo FM receiver, the C230 is good for daily use. The FM playback can be diverted to the sufficiently loud speaker. However, you need to connect the headset as it's the receiving antenna.

Samsung has greatly improved user interface and it's now easy to grasp and use. It also has a 1,000-number phone book, 2 MB of memory, polyphonic ringtones and supports Java applications. GPRS and infrared are the preferred choices for PC connectivity. Sensibly priced at Rs 5,999, the SGH-C230 makes for an excellent entry-level phone.



Company **Samsung India Electronics Ltd**

Price **Rs 5,999**

Phone **011-51511234**

E-mail **vikas.tagra@samsung.com**

Web site **www.samsungindia.com**

Rating



Creative DiVi CAM 316

Multiple Personality

Very similar in looks and functionality to the Samsung Miniket reviewed earlier (*Digit*, July 2005), the DiVi CAM 316 from Creative works as a digital camera, digital video camera, Web cam, MP3 player and voice recorder.

However, the Creative DiVi CAM has a lot less to speak about in terms of features as compared to the Miniket.

The Miniket boasted of 1 GB memory, 10X optical zoom and a Lithium-ion rechargeable battery whereas the DiVi CAM 316 has just 16 MB internal memory, no optical zoom, and is powered by 4 AAA batteries. However, as with the Miniket, the memory is expandable using the SD expansion slot.

One area, though, where Creative scores over the Miniket is image resolution. The DiVi CAM 316 features a 3.1 megapixel CMOS sensor and can go up to 6.6 megapixels with interpolation.

You can capture stills in JPEG format in 2976 x 2232, 2048 x 1536, 1600 x 1200 and 640 x 480 resolutions, whereas videos can be captured in MPEG-4 format at 640 x 480 or 320 x 240 resolutions. You can preview and review captured images on the 1.6-inch TFT display that can swivel 270 degrees.



Other features include 4X digital zoom, self-timer, macro mode and TV-out functionality in the NTSC or PAL formats. The flash can be set to Auto or OFF whereas white balance can be set to Auto, Sunny, Tungsten, Fluorescent or cloudy.

The interface and button placement is not very intuitive and takes time getting used to. You also need to install the bundled drivers before it is detected as a removable drive. However, what it lacks in features, the DiVi CAM 316 makes up in performance. The images captured are decent, though videos could have been better. MP3 playback is ok and the same can be said about voice recording.

Overall, the Creative DiVi CAM 316 is a decent all-round device, though you will definitely need to purchase an SD card and rechargeable AAA batteries to use it effectively. A word of advice: Try out the interface before you decide to buy.

Company **Creative Technology Ltd**

Price **Rs 10,499**

Phone **0-9820357718**

E-mail **india_getcreative@ctl.creative.com**

Web site **www.creative.com**

Rating

